

Core Competencies

Science

May, 2026



**SE
TU**

Ollscoil
Teicneolaíochta
an Oirdheiscirt

South East
Technological
University

Core Competencies (A11533)

Short Title:	Core Competencies	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Science	
Cluster	Quality, Regulatory and Compliance	
Author	BWHELAN	
Credits	5	Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module will enable the student to develop learning and information handling strategies, scientific report writing and critical thinking skills essential to study at third level, and to increase their awareness of the pharmaceutical business enterprise.

Programmes

PHAR-0015 Higher Certificate in Science in Good Manufacturing Practice and Technology 1 / 1 / M
(WD_SGMPT_C)

Indicative Content

- Guide to learning styles, critical thinking strategies
- Scientific writing, report writing, referencing conventions; introduction to research methodology
- Presentation skills
- Managing meetings at work, effective decision making, project management
- Motivation, time and information managing skills
- Introduction to reflective practice: developing reflective skills; understanding the need for reflective practice
- Leadership skills: persuading, strategic thinking, intuitive decision making, networking

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Identify learning strategies and intelligences.
2. Complete scientific reports using appropriate writing skills and library searching techniques.
3. Recognise and employ techniques of critical thinking, construction of argument and decision-making.
4. Express themselves both orally and in writing using technology as an aid.
5. Demonstrate skills, attitudes and behaviours appropriate to managing or working in a successful business enterprise.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Group discussion.
- Case studies.
- Role play.
- Guest speaker.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
<i>Presentation</i>	40%	3,4
<i>Case Studies</i>	60%	1,2,5

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very little knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Unable to carry out critical thinking or practical skills.

40%-49%: Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. May have some problems with critical thinking and problem-solving. Adequate practical skills.

50%-59%: Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Good practical skills.

60%-69%: Demonstrate skilled and sound knowledge of the subject matter. Show ability to analyse and logically discuss in an effective way. Good critical thinking and a high level of competence and efficiency in theoretical and practical areas of this subject.

70%-100%: All of the above to an excellent level. Demonstrate authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture		12
Independent Learning		123

Essential Material

- Covey, S.R. *_The 7 habits of highly effective people_*. London: Simon & Schuster UK, 2004.
- Northedge, A. *_The Good Study Guide_*. Milton Keynes: Open University, 2005.
- Stott, R., A. Snaith and R. Rylance. *_Making your case: a practical guide to essay writing_*. New York: Longman, 2000.

Supplementary Material

- Covey, S.R. *_First things First_*. London: Simon & Schuster UK, 1999.
- Covey, S.R. *_Principle-centred leadership_*. London: Simon & Schuster UK, 1999.